

# Contents

|                                 |   |
|---------------------------------|---|
| 0.1 Cantor Set . . . . .        | 1 |
| 0.2 Ternary Expansion . . . . . | 2 |

## 0.1 Cantor Set

Define operations on  $\mathcal{P}(\mathbb{R})$  as: for  $A, B \subset \mathbb{R}$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ ,

$$A + B \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{a + b \mid a \in A, b \in B\}$$

$$cA \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{ca \mid a \in A\}$$

If  $A = \{\alpha\}$  is a singleton, denote  $A + B$  as  $\alpha + B$ .

**Definition 0.1.1.** Let  $C_0 \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} [0, 1]$  and  $C_n \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \frac{C_{n-1}}{3} \cup \left(\frac{2}{3} + \frac{C_{n-1}}{3}\right)$ , for  $n \geq 1$ .

An intersection  $C = \bigcap_{n=1}^{\infty} C_n$  is called a *Cantor Set*.

Cantor set is a remarkable object in the Real numbers set.

In particularly, Cantor Set is *Uncountable*, *Compact*, *Perfect*, *Nowhere Dense*, and has *Measure zero*.

Moreover, sum of two Cantor sets is  $[0, 2]$ .

## 0.2 Ternary Expansion

**Definition 0.2.1.** Given  $x \in (0, 1)$ , a sequence  $\{n_i\}_{i=1}^{\infty}$  in  $\{0, 1, 2\}$  is called a *ternary expansion* of  $x$  if:

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i}{3^i}$$

**Theorem 0.2.2.** Given  $x \in (0, 1)$ , a ternary expansion of  $x$  exists.

*Proof.* Let  $x \in (0, 1)$  be given. We construct the sequence  $\{n_i\}$  inductively as follows:  
First, choose  $n_1 \in \{0, 1, 2\}$  to be the largest integer such that

$$\frac{n_1}{3} < x$$

Next, for chosen  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_{k-1}$ , we choose the largest digit  $n_k \in \{0, 1, 2\}$  such that

$$\frac{n_1}{3} + \frac{n_2}{3^2} + \dots + \frac{n_{k-1}}{3^{k-1}} + \frac{n_k}{3^k} < x$$

From this construction of  $\{n_i\}$ , it follows that for any  $k \in \mathbb{N}$ ,

$$\sum_{i=1}^k \frac{n_i}{3^i} < x \leq \sum_{i=1}^k \frac{n_i}{3^i} + \frac{1}{3^k}$$

Note that the partial sum  $\sum_{i=1}^k \frac{n_i}{3^i}$  increases monotonically and is bounded by 1, thus it converges.  
Taking the limit as  $k \rightarrow \infty$  in the above inequality, we obtain:

$$\sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i}{3^i} \leq x \leq \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i}{3^i} + \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{3^k}$$

Since  $\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{3^k} = 0$ , we have

$$x = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i}{3^i}$$

which gives the desired result. □

Note: the ternary expansion described in the existence theorem is called the *First-form* ternary expansion.

**Theorem 0.2.3.** Given  $x \in (0, 1)$ , the ternary expansion of  $x$  is unique except: for some  $m \in \mathbb{N}$  and  $0 < a < 3^m$ ,

$$x = \frac{a}{3^m}, \text{ irreducible form} \quad (*)$$

Particularly, if  $x$  can be represented as  $(*)$ , it has only two different ternary expansion.

*Proof.* First, we show that if  $x$  is of the form  $(*)$ , it has only two expansions. If  $x$  can be represented as  $(*)$ , then

$$x = \frac{a}{3^m} = \frac{a_1}{3} + \frac{a_2}{3^2} + \cdots + \frac{a_m}{3^m}$$

where  $a_i \in \{0, 1, 2\}$  with  $a_m \neq 0$ . It is obtained by the Euclidean Algorithm:

$$a = 3^{m-1}a_1 + 3^{m-2}a_2 + \cdots + 3^2a_{m-2} + 3a_{m-1} + a_m$$

(If  $a_m = 0$ , then  $x$  can be divided by 3, it is contradiction to irreducibility.) Meanwhile, note that

$$\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} \frac{2}{3^k} = \frac{2}{3^{m+1}} \cdot \frac{1}{1 - 1/3} = \frac{2}{3^{m+1}} \cdot \frac{3}{2} = \frac{1}{3^m}.$$

Therefore, we obtain two ternary expansion of  $x$  as:

$$x = \frac{a_1}{3} + \frac{a_2}{3^2} + \cdots + \frac{a_m}{3^m} + \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} \frac{0}{3^k} = \frac{a_1}{3} + \frac{a_2}{3^2} + \cdots + \frac{a_m - 1}{3^m} + \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} \frac{2}{3^k} \quad (**)$$

This proves that such  $x$  has two distinct expansions. Meanwhile, suppose that  $x$  has two distinct expansions  $\{n_i\}, \{r_i\}$ . Let  $j \in \mathbb{N}$  be the smallest index such that  $n_j \neq r_j$ . Since  $n_i = r_i$  for all  $i < j$ , we have:

$$0 = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i - r_i}{3^i} = \frac{n_j - r_j}{3^j} + \sum_{i=j+1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i - r_i}{3^i} \quad (***)$$

Since  $n_j \neq r_j$  and

$$\left| \sum_{i=j+1}^{\infty} \frac{n_i - r_i}{3^i} \right| \leq \sum_{i=j+1}^{\infty} \frac{2}{3^i} = \frac{1}{3^j}$$

the  $(***)$  holds if and only if

$$n_j - r_j = 1, n_i - r_i = -2 \text{ for all } i \geq j+1 \text{ or } n_j - r_j = -1, n_i - r_i = 2 \text{ for all } i \geq j+1$$

But this equivalent to  $x$  can be represented in the form of  $(*)$ , therefore we proved the Uniqueness.  $\square$

Note: the ternary expansion is of the form  $(*)$  has two expansions. Clearly, the left side in  $(**)$  is a first form. The right side form is called a *Second form*.